

BOARD *signature licks*



INCLUDED

BILL EVANS

A Step-by-Step Breakdown
of the Piano Styles and Techniques
of a Jazz Legend

by Brent Edstrom

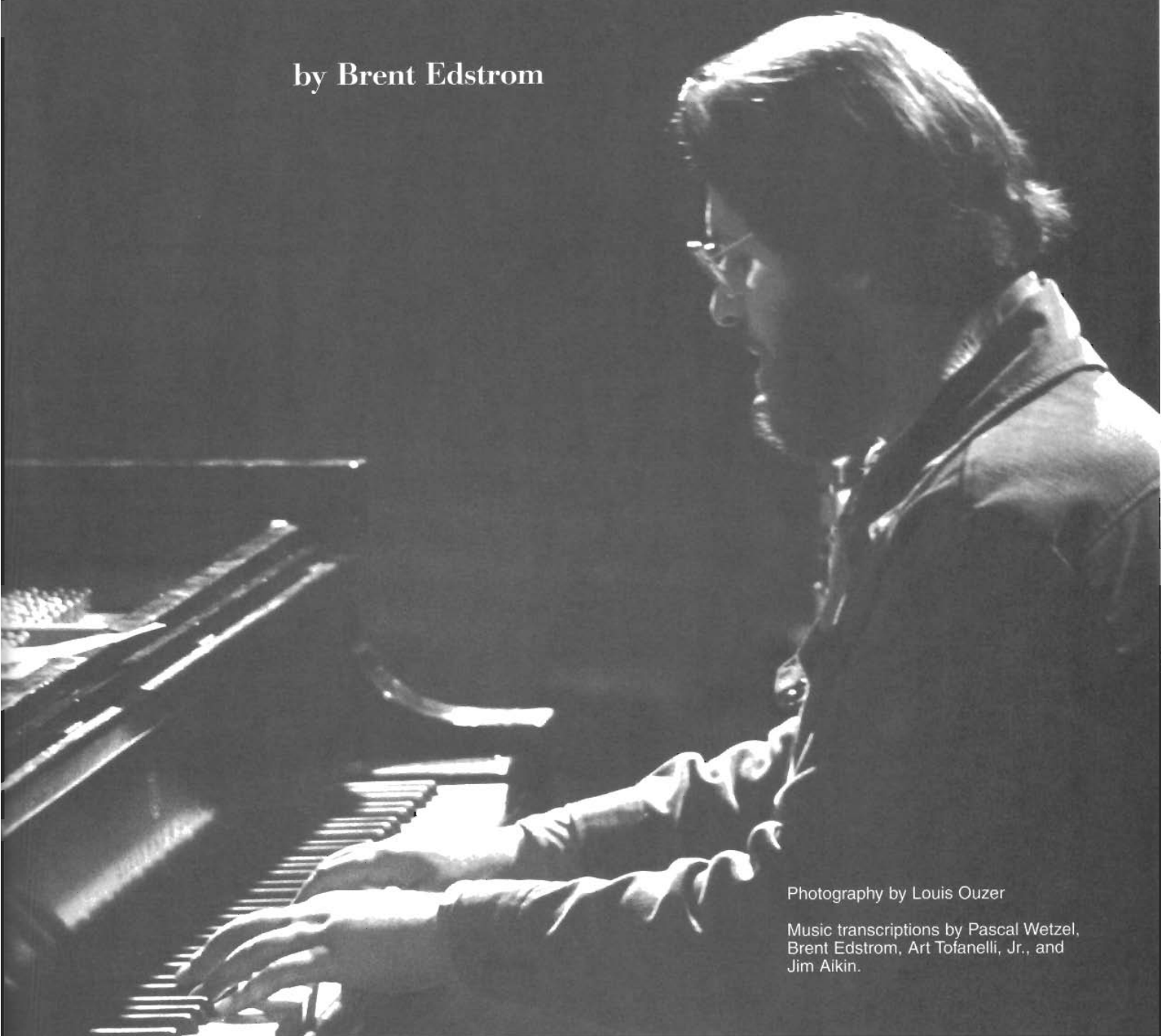


TRO

KEYBOARD *signature picks*

BILL EVANS

by Brent Edstrom



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Brent Edstrom, Art Tofanelli, Jr., and
Jim Aikin.

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INTRODUCTION

If one had to make a list of the most influential jazz pianists, there is no question that Bill Evans would rank amongst the top. His many notable contributions to jazz include his refined touch and control, remarkable lyricism, amazing voicings, and harmonic and rhythmic innovation, to name a few. In addition to his many contributions as a pianist, Evans wrote a number of well-known jazz standards, including “Waltz for Debby” and “Peri’s Scope.”

Bill Evans had the ability to sculpt a standard tune or original composition into a work of art. Although his style is unmistakable—you can often tell in a few bars that Evans is the pianist—his performances were always fresh and imaginative.

It is not a big stretch to think that Evans was capable of so much; he worked hard at his music. Like John Coltrane and other jazz greats, Bill Evans practiced his craft with intensity. He also immersed himself in the music of many jazz innovators. You hear so many influences in his style, including the locked hands of Milt Buckner and Nat Cole, occasional left-hand patterns reminiscent of Red Garland and Erroll Garner, a touch of stride (listen to the third section of “Turn out the Stars”), and a right hand that is, at once, a tribute to the vocabulary of Bud Powell and Lee Konitz and a glimpse into the future of jazz.

I hope you enjoy working through the book as much as I enjoyed preparing it.

—Brent Edstrom

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Brent Edstrom teaches at Whitworth College, where he coordinates the music theory and composition program. Edstrom has published numerous books with Hal Leonard Corporation, including *The Art Tatum Collection*, *Art Tatum Solo Book*, and *The Kenny Barron Collection*. He recently wrote *Making Music With Your Computer*, revised edition for EMBooks/artistpro.com and is currently working on a book on the topic of computer notation algorithms in C++. An active performer and composer, Edstrom has performed throughout the United States. His compositions and arrangements have been featured by such ensembles as the Spokane Symphony Orchestra, Spokane Jazz Orchestra, and the Eastman Jazz Ensemble.

THE RECORDING

Selections in this Signature Licks volume were recorded three ways:

- 1) As a full demo with the piano panned to the right and the rhythm section to the left; the piano parts can be panned out completely or isolated for close study.
- 2) Slow demos of notable piano excerpts.
- 3) A full mix with just bass and drums (and piano cues, where necessary).

Brent Edstrom, piano
Clipper Anderson, bass
Mark Ivester, drums

Trio selections recorded by David Lange at David Lange studios.

PERI'S SCOPE

Music by Bill Evans

As Played on *Bill Evans, Montreux II*

Figure 1—Intro, Head, and Solo

This version of “Peri’s Scope” comes from Evans’s *Montreux II* recording. The original recording is rather frenetic—the trio starts fast and gets faster—almost to the point of being too fast to play. We took our version a touch slower for teaching purposes.

One of the most striking features of the head is the cross-rhythm in measures 15–18. It is important to try to feel across the barlines in this section. Throughout the head and much of the solo chorus, Evans uses close-position voicings in the left hand. Sometimes he would leave a note out in what classical theorists would call a *chord of omission*. These structures are an unmistakable part of Evans’s piano style. It is interesting to note that, while he often uses a 9th on the ii chord (Dm7), he avoids the 9th on the iii chord. The addition of a 9th on an Em7 chord (F♯) is not found in the key. You will find that this is typical for Bill Evans—he is sensitive to the strength of the key. Chromatic chord tones are most often used in “functional” applications (i.e. a tonicizing chord such as an altered dominant or applied dominant).

One of the most important elements of the solo is the vertical approach Evans uses in many places. The solo break in measures 25–26, for example, outlines a Cmaj9 chord (the D♭ and G♯ function as chromatic passing or approach tones). In addition to chord outlines and chromatic embellishments, Evans uses some interesting upper-structure chords. A notable example occurs in measure 48: here Evans outlines a descending A♭m6 chord over the G7 altered harmony. An A♭m6, or A♭m(maj7), is found in a common chord-scale relationship: A♭ melodic minor (ascending) over G7—one of the common “altered” scales. A highlight of this solo occurs in measures 57–58, where Evans uses ascending augmented chords in the right hand. These chords (C+, D+, E+, and F#+) come from the E whole tone scale.

- | | |
|---|--------------------------|
| 1 | Full Band |
| 2 | Slow Demo
meas. 53-58 |
| 3 | Rhythm Track |

Fig. 1

Intro
Medium Uptempo Swing ♩ = 200

Head

1 *f*

5 Dm7 G13 Em7 A7 Dm9 G13

8 C6 E13 E+7 E7 E7b5

11 Dm7 G13 Em7 Am7 Dm9 G13 Gm9/C C7

15 Fmaj7 B+7 Bb+7 A+7

19 Dm7 G7 Em7 Am7 Dm7 G7 Em7b5 A7

23 Dm9 G11 C/G

Solo 27 Dm7 G7 Em7 A7alt. Dm7 G13

30 Em7 A7alt. Dm9 G13 C♯

33 E7alt. Dm7 G13 Em7 A7alt.

37 Dm9 G13 Gm9/C C13 Fmaj7 B+7

41 Bb+7 A+7 Dm7 G7 Em7 A7alt

45 Dm7 G7 Em7b5 A7 Dm9

48 G7alt. C♯ Dm9 C♯ A7alt.

51 Dm7 G7 Em7 A7alt. Dm7 G13 Em7 A7alt.

55 Dm9 G13 C# E7alt.

58 Dm7 G13 Em7 A7alt.

61 Dm9 G13 Gm9/C C13 Fmaj7 B+7

65 Bb+7 A+7 Dm7 G7 Em7 A7alt.

69 Dm7 G7 Em7b5 A7 Dm9 G9

QUIET NOW

Music by Denny Zeitlin

As Played on *The Paris Concert Edition One*

Figure 2—Solo Excerpt

As is typical for Evans, the solo on “Quiet Now” is economical—it’s almost as if he had written this down on paper first. In this solo we glimpse his mastery of motive and development. The opening phrase leads us to a simple descending line (alternating with a pedal point) in measure 4. Note how this motive (D–D $\flat$ –C–B–A) leads to a transposed repetition in measure 5 (G–G $\flat$ –F–E–D). Evans embellishes the motive with a turn in measure 6 and returns to the melodic pedal of B to finish with a final statement (D–D $\flat$ –C–B–A). It is also interesting to note that Evans uses rhythmic displacement for each of the statements of the motive: discounting the embellishments, you will see that he places the motive on beats 1, 2, 3, and 1, respectively. Sing or play this phrase several times, and you will see Evans’s mastery at work. If you look at the remainder of the solo excerpt, it becomes clear that this simple motive is a unifying device for the solo.

Fig. 2
Solo
♩ = 73

1 Dm9 G13 C $\sharp$ Fmaj9 Bm7 $\flat$ 5 E7 Am9

5 Fmaj7 Bm7 $\flat$ 5 E7 $\sharp$ 9 Am9 A+7 Dm9 G13

9 C $\sharp$ Fmaj7 B $\flat$ 13 A+7

12 Dm11 E7alt. Am9 D $\sharp$ o7 Cmaj7/E

4 Full Band
5 Slow Demo meas. 16-24
6 Rhythm Track

17 Eb9 Abmaj7 Db13

20 Bm9 Gmaj7 Db7#9 Gb13

23 Bm9 Em9 A13 8va Dmaj13 Gmaj7 loco

26 C13#11 B+7 8va Em9 A13 C#7b5 F#7#9

30 Bm9 8va E9 F#7 Bm9 Em9 A13

34 Am9/D Begin fade D7b9 Gmaj9 C13#11 Fade Out

ONE FOR HELEN

Music by Bill Evans

As Played on *Bill Evans at Town Hall*

Figure 3 – Head to Bass Solo

“One for Helen” was one of the more challenging pieces to record for this volume. Although the piece is not overly fast, it is no easy task to mimic Evans’s subtlety and control. Here we see his use of close-position left-hand structures as well as many chords of omission (measures 5, 8, 9, 10, 27, etc.).

As with many great jazz solos, chord tones play an important role. Note the use of descending augmented triads in measures 87–91: A^b+ , G^+ , G^b+ , F^+ , and E^+ . Although it is simple to play, the figure is quite effective. A similar use of descending upper structure chords can be heard in measures 81–82.

One of the most striking features of this solo is the tremendous rhythmic variety. Evans uses swing eighths, triplet eighths, and triplet quarter notes, among other rhythms. This rhythmic energy culminates in the tricky passage in measures 123–130. My best advice here is to play the passage slowly until it becomes second nature.

Evans is very specific in his approach to tonic-minor chords in this piece. Although he plays a $Cm6$ in the left hand for each tonic chord in the piece, he uses $B^{\natural}$ as an approach tone to the tonic note in the right hand and B^b as a melodic tone for any chord outlines.

Fig. 3

A
Fast Swing ♩ = 184

Measures 1-13 of the solo. Chords indicated above the staff include $Dm9^b5$, G^+7 , $Cm7$, $Fm11$, B^b7 , $Am7^b5$, $D7^{alt}$, $Gm7^b5$, $C9$, $Fm7$, $Fm7/E^b$, $D9$, $D7^{alt.}$, $G13$, and G^+7 .

7

Full Band

8

Slow Demo
meas. 47-63

9

Rhythm Track

15 C11 C13 F7 **B** Bb7alt. Eb7#11 Ab+7 Db+7 F#9

22 B+7 E13 A7alt. **C** Cm9b5 G+7 Gm7b5

28 C+7 Fm9 Bb7alt. Eb9 Ab13 G+7

33 Cm# Solo break **A** Dm9b5 G+7

37 Cm# Fm9 Bb13

41 Am7b5 D7 Gm7b5 C7

45 Fm9 D7#9 G7b9

49 C11 C13 F9 Bb13 Eb7#9

53 Ab13 A+7 Db9 F#7+ B13

57 E9 A13 Ab13 G+7

61 Gm7b5 C7 Fm9 Bb13

65 A13 Ab13 G+7 Cm6 A13

A

69 $A\flat 13$ $G+7$ $Cm\sharp$

Measures 69-72. Treble staff: 69 (quarter, eighth, quarter, quarter), 70 (quarter, eighth, quarter, quarter), 71 (quarter, eighth, quarter, quarter), 72 (quarter, eighth, quarter, quarter). Bass staff: 69 (quarter, quarter, quarter, quarter), 70 (quarter, quarter, quarter, quarter), 71 (quarter, quarter, quarter, quarter), 72 (quarter, quarter, quarter, quarter). Chords: $A\flat 13$ (69), $G+7$ (70), $Cm\sharp$ (71, 72). Triplets are marked in measures 70 and 72.

73 $Fm9$ $B\flat 13$ $Am7\flat 5$ $D7\flat 9$

Measures 73-76. Treble staff: 73 (quarter, eighth, quarter, quarter), 74 (quarter, eighth, quarter, quarter), 75 (quarter, eighth, quarter, quarter), 76 (quarter, eighth, quarter, quarter). Bass staff: 73 (quarter, quarter, quarter, quarter), 74 (quarter, quarter, quarter, quarter), 75 (quarter, quarter, quarter, quarter), 76 (quarter, quarter, quarter, quarter). Chords: $Fm9$ (73), $B\flat 13$ (74), $Am7\flat 5$ (75), $D7\flat 9$ (76). Triplets are marked in measures 73 and 74.

77 $Gm7\flat 5$ $C7$ $Fm9$

Measures 77-80. Treble staff: 77 (quarter, eighth, quarter, quarter), 78 (quarter, eighth, quarter, quarter), 79 (quarter, eighth, quarter, quarter), 80 (quarter, eighth, quarter, quarter). Bass staff: 77 (quarter, quarter, quarter, quarter), 78 (quarter, quarter, quarter, quarter), 79 (quarter, quarter, quarter, quarter), 80 (quarter, quarter, quarter, quarter). Chords: $Gm7\flat 5$ (77), $C7$ (78), $Fm9$ (79, 80). Triplets are marked in measures 79 and 80.

81 $D7alt.$ $G7\flat 5$ $C13$ $F9$

Measures 81-84. Treble staff: 81 (quarter, eighth, quarter, quarter), 82 (quarter, eighth, quarter, quarter), 83 (quarter, eighth, quarter, quarter), 84 (quarter, eighth, quarter, quarter). Bass staff: 81 (quarter, quarter, quarter, quarter), 82 (quarter, quarter, quarter, quarter), 83 (quarter, quarter, quarter, quarter), 84 (quarter, quarter, quarter, quarter). Chords: $D7alt.$ (81), $G7\flat 5$ (82), $C13$ (83), $F9$ (84). Triplets are marked in measures 81 and 83.

B

85 $B\flat 13$ $E\flat 9$ $A\flat +7$ $G+7$

Measures 85-88. Treble staff: 85 (quarter, eighth, quarter, quarter), 86 (quarter, eighth, quarter, quarter), 87 (quarter, eighth, quarter, quarter), 88 (quarter, eighth, quarter, quarter). Bass staff: 85 (quarter, quarter, quarter, quarter), 86 (quarter, quarter, quarter, quarter), 87 (quarter, quarter, quarter, quarter), 88 (quarter, quarter, quarter, quarter). Chords: $B\flat 13$ (85), $E\flat 9$ (86), $A\flat +7$ (87), $G+7$ (88). Triplets are marked in measures 85 and 87.

89 $G\flat 13$ $B9$ $E+7$ $A+7$

Measures 89-92. Treble staff: 89 (quarter, eighth, quarter, quarter), 90 (quarter, eighth, quarter, quarter), 91 (quarter, eighth, quarter, quarter), 92 (quarter, eighth, quarter, quarter). Bass staff: 89 (quarter, quarter, quarter, quarter), 90 (quarter, quarter, quarter, quarter), 91 (quarter, quarter, quarter, quarter), 92 (quarter, quarter, quarter, quarter). Chords: $G\flat 13$ (89), $B9$ (90), $E+7$ (91), $A+7$ (92). Triplets are marked in measures 91 and 92.

C

93 Ab13 G+7 Gm7b5 C13

Fm9 Bb13 A13 Ab13 G+7

A

101 Cm6 Ab13 G+7

Cm6 Fm9 Bb13

109 Am7b5 D7b9 Gm7b5 C13b9

mf

113 Fm9 D7#9 G+7

117

C11 C13 Fm9 F9 **B** Bb13 Eb7#9

121

Ab13 Db9 F#7 B13 E9

125

A+7 Ab13 **C** G+7

129

Gm7b5 C7b9 Fm9 Bb13 A13

134

Ab13 G+7 Cm9 Eb9 **A** Ab13 G+7

139

Cm9 Fm9 Bb9 Am7b5

144 D7b9 Gm7b5 C13b9 Fm9

148 D7b9 G+7 C9 F7#9

B Bb+7 Eb9 Ab+7 Db9 Gb+7

153

B13 E9 A13

157

C Ab13 G+7 Gm7b5 C13 Fm9

161

166 Bb13 A13 Ab13 G7 Cm# Eb7

RE: PERSON I KNEW

Music by Bill Evans

As played on *Moonbeams*

Figure 4—Intro

“Re: Person I Knew” has a groove somewhat reminiscent of the Ahmad Jamal trio. Although there are many interesting components of Evans’s solo, one of the most interesting licks occurs in measure 65. Here, Evans uses descending scale-tone triads over Cmaj9, Gm(maj7), Gm7, and Fm7. For the Cmaj9 chord (meas. 65–66) he uses triads from the C major scale: D–B–G, C–A–F, B–G–E, A–F–D, G–E–C. Note that the chromatic tones are used as approach tones to embellish the scale-tone chords. Evans uses a similar approach in measures 67–69: a series of descending scale-tone triads preceded by a chromatic approach note. Of course, this passage also strikes the ear because of the interesting rhythm; Evans creates the effect of a cross-rhythm by grouping four adjacent tones from the triplet eighths. The effect is striking.

A similar passage can be found at measures 101–104. Although this passage sounds rather difficult, it consists simply of a series of eighth-note triplets. Art Tatum is another well-known pianist who often utilized these streams of eighth-note triplets. These types of figures tend to propel the music forward. In a sense, they sound more complicated than they really are.

Evans uses wonderful pacing on this solo. At first, we find short phrases punctuated by deliberate rests. As the solo progresses, he uses less frequent rests and more active rhythmic lines. Notice how he develops the half-step F♯–G motive in measures 90–95, which leads us, over the next phrase, to the penultimate lick in measure 101.

10	Full Band
11	Slow Demo meas. 65-70
12	Slow Demo meas. 101-105
13	Rhythm Track

Fig. 4

Intro
Rubato ♩ = 102

The musical score for the introduction of "Re: Person I Knew" is presented in two systems. The first system begins with a piano (pp) dynamic and features a series of descending scale-tone triads over the following chords: Cmaj9, Gm(maj7), Gm7, and Fm7. The second system continues with Cm(add9), Fm7, Cm(add9), Fm(maj7), and Gm(maj7). The notation includes eighth-note triplets and descending scale-tone triads, with a tempo marking of ♩ = 102.

13 Fm(maj7) Gm7 A♭maj7 D♭maj7

rit. poco rit.

17 ♩ = 160 Cmaj9 Gm(maj7) Gm7 Fm7

23 Cm(add9) Fm7 Cm(add9) Fm7

28 Gm(maj7) Fm(maj7) Gm7 A♭maj7 D♭maj7

33 Cmaj9 Gm(maj7) Gm7 Fm7

38 Cm(add9) Fm7 Cm(add9)

43 Fm(maj7) Gm(maj7) Fm(maj7) Gm7 Abmaj7

48 Dbmaj7 Cmaj9 Gm(maj7) Gm7

53 Fm7 *loco* Cm(add9) Fm7

58 Cm(add9) Fm(maj7) Gm(maj7) Fm(maj7) Gm7

63 Abmaj7 Dbmaj7 Cmaj9

67 Gm(maj7) Gm7 Fm7

71 Cm(add9) Fm7 Cm(add9)

75 Fm(maj7) Gm(maj7) Fm(maj7)

78 Gm7 Abmaj7 Dbmaj7 Cmaj9

82 Gm(maj7) Gm7 Fm7

86 Cm(add9) Fm7

90 Cm(add9) Fm(maj7) Gm(maj7) Fm7

94 Gm7 A♭maj7 D♭maj7 Cmaj9

98 Gm(maj7) Gm7 Fm7

102 Cm(add9)

105 Fm7 Cm(add9) Fm7 Gmaj7

109 Fm(maj7) Gm7 A♭maj7 D♭maj7 Cmaj7

WALTZ FOR DEBBY

Lyric by Gene Lees

Music by Bill Evans

As Played on *Waltz for Debby*

Figure 5—Solo

This piece represents the hard-swinging side of Bill Evans. It is interesting to note that, though the head is a waltz, Evans usually played the solo chorus in common time. One feature that works so well in this solo is his marvelous development of motive. Notice how the first section (meas. 1–8) can be divided into two complementary sections, each of which sticks to a basic idea. You can follow this deliberate development of motive through much of the solo. Of course, the melody of the tune is never very far away—compare, for example, his note choice in measures 25–32 with the original melody.

I once heard a professor talk about Bill Evans's approach to rhythm as a series of rhythmic "streams." Evans has a unique way of combining various rhythmic elements such as swing eighths, eighth-note triplets, quarter-note triplets, and even double time (meas. 57). Where most performers might use these rhythms in a solo, Evans combines them in a way that is unique. Notice the variety of rhythms in measures 52–64. These "streams" really propel the music forward.

14

Full Band

15

Slow Demo
meas. 55-62

16

Rhythm Track

Fig. 5

Solo

Moderately ♩ = 165

Fig. 5 Solo, Moderately ♩ = 165. The musical score is presented in three systems, each with a treble and bass staff. Chord symbols are placed above the measures: Fmaj7, D7#9, Gm9, C13 (8va), Am11 D7#9, Gm7 loco, C13, A+7, Dm7, Gm9, C7, Fmaj7, Dm9, Gm9, C13, Fmaj7, D7#9, Gm9, C13, A+7, D9, Gm9, C13, A+7, Dm9. The score includes various rhythmic markings such as triplets and slurs. The tempo is marked 'Moderately' with a quarter note equal to 165 beats per minute.

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14 Bm7b5 E7alt. Amaj7₃ Gm9 C13

18 Fmaj9 D7 Gm7 A7 Cm7 F7 Bbmaj7 A+7

22 Dm(maj9) G9 Abmaj7 Dbmaj7 Gm7 C13 Fmaj9 D7#9

26 Gm7 C13/Bb A+7 Ab+7 Gm9 C13/E A+7 Dm9

30 Gm7 C13 Am7 D9 Bm9b5 E7alt. Am7 F13/A

34 Bbmaj7 Eb9 Dm9 G7#11 Fmaj7/C

38 Gm9 C13 Fmaj9 F°7 Gm9 C13 Fmaj7 D7#9

42 Gm9 C13 A+7 D9 Gm9 C13 A+7 D7#9

46 Gm9 C13 Am9 Dm9 Gm9 C13 Fmaj9 D7#9

50 Gm9 C13 A+7 D7#9 Gm9 C13 A7#9 Dm9

54 Bm7b5 E7alt. Amaj7

57 Gm7 Gm7/C D13/A

59 Gm9 A+7 Dm9 F13 Bbmaj7 A+7

62 Dm6 G9 Abmaj7 Dbmaj9 Gm7 C13 Fmaj7 D7#9 Gm9 C13

67 A+7 D9 Gm7 C13 A7 Dm7 Gm7 C13 Am11 D9 Bm11 E9

73 Cmaj7 B7alt. Bbmaj7 A+7 Dm9 G13

77 Fmaj/C G#o7/C Gm7/C Db9/C Fmaj9/C G#o7/C

80 Gm7/C Db9/C Fmaj9 D7#9 Gm9 C9 A+7 D9

PEACE PIECE

Music by Bill Evans
As Played on *Everybody Digs Bill Evans*

Figure 6—Piano Solo

“Peace Piece” is as much a study of “legit” composition as it is jazz improvisation. It is also a testament to Bill Evans’s abilities as an improviser that he could create such an amazing composition out of such simple elements.

“Peace Piece” is organized around a simple ostinato figure in the left hand. Evans does take a few liberties with the chords and rhythms of the ostinato, but these exceptions are mostly at cadence points.

The most intriguing section of “Peace Piece” occurs when he moves away from C major in measure 43. Here we hear a genius at work; Evans uses a free tonal approach that is reminiscent of some of Sergei Prokofiev’s music. As with all great composers, Evans utilizes balance—the return to C major in measure 68 provides symmetry to the composition.

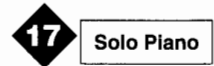


Fig. 6

Piano Solo
Gently, with rubato ♩ = 50

14

p *mf*

17

rall. *a tempo*

20

p *ppp* *8va* *loco* 6 3 3

23

p *ppp* *8va* *loco* 3 5 5 5

rall. *a tempo*

26

mf *p* *ppp*

29

pp *rall.* *f* *a tempo* 3 3 3

32 *grace notes simile*

6

35 *8va* *simile*

6 *mp* 3 3 3

38 *8va*

5 3 3

41 *8va* *loco*

5 6 5

43 *8va* *simile* *simile*

3 *mf* 3 *p*

46 *8va*

3 5

48 *8va*----- *15ma*-----

f 5 3

50 *15ma*----- *8va*-----

7 3 6 3

52 *8va*-----

3 *loco* *mf*

56 *8va*----- *loco* 9

6 7 *f*

58 *8va*-----

3 5 *p*

[illegible]

8va--

63

mp

5

3

mf

3

3

3

3

65 *8va.*

pp *mp*

8va

67

mf

loco

3

pp

mp

71

p

pp

mf

ppp

p

TIME REMEMBERED

Music by Bill Evans

As Played on *The Bill Evans Trio with Symphony Orchestra*

Figure 7—Solo

Bill Evans recorded "Time Remembered" with a symphony orchestra. Notice how he develops the descending 4th motive starting in measure 5. As with many of his solos, he uses rhythmic variation to provide interest for this simple motive.

Evans uses a vertical approach for much of this solo. One of the most interesting examples occurs in measures 13–21. Here he uses chord-tone arpeggiations to great effect. Note that he uses extensions such as 9ths, 11ths, and 13ths in this passage.

Evans takes an almost playful approach in measures 33–38. The clipped-sounding left hand works against the lyrical right-hand line in this section. His use of steady rhythmic comping brings to mind the left-hand style of Erroll Garner, who typically used four quarter-note chords in his left hand against a melody or solo line in the right hand.

18	Full Band
19	Slow Demo meas. 12-16
20	Rhythm Track

Fig. 7

Solo
Medium Ballad ♩ = 130

Chord symbols: Bm9, Cmaj7#11, Fmaj7#11, Bm9, Am9, Dm9, Gm9, Ebmaj7, Abmaj7, Am9, Dm9, Gm9, Cm9, Fm11, Em11, Bm11.

16 Eb m11 Am9

19 Cm11 F#m9 Bm9

22 Gm9 Eb maj9#11 Dm9 Cm9

26 Bm9 Cmaj9 Fmaj9 Em11

31 Am9 Dm9 Gm9 Eb maj7

Abmaj9 Am9 Dm9 Gm9 Ebmaj9

34 3

3

39 Abmaj9 Em11 Bm9 Dmaj7#11

Measures 43 and 44 of the musical score for "The Sound of Silence" by Simon & Garfunkel. The key signature is E-flat major (three flats). Measure 43 features a treble clef with a whole rest, followed by a series of eighth and sixteenth notes, and a bass clef with a whole rest. Measure 44 features a treble clef with a series of eighth and sixteenth notes, and a bass clef with a whole rest. The score includes a key signature change to A-flat major (four flats) at the end of measure 44.

48 $B\flat$ maj7 $E\flat$ maj9 Dm9 Cm9

The musical score for measures 48-51 of 'The Sound of Silence' is shown. Measure 48 features a treble clef with a melodic line and a bass clef with a bass line. The key signature has two flats (B-flat and E-flat). The chords are B-flat major 7, E-flat major 9, D minor 9, and C minor 9. The melody in measure 48 is: G4 (quarter), A4-B4 (beamed eighth notes), C5 (quarter), B4-A4 (beamed eighth notes), G4 (quarter), F#4 (quarter), E4 (half). The bass line in measure 48 is: B2 (quarter), C3 (quarter), D3 (quarter), E3 (quarter), F3 (quarter), G3 (half). Measures 49-51 continue the harmonic progression with the same chords and a similar melodic/bass structure.

THE OPENER

Music by Bill Evans
As Played on *I Will Say Goodbye*

Figure 8—Intro and Solo

It was a joy to work on the luscious harmonies in the first part of “The Opener.” Here we see the refined side of Bill Evans as a master of harmony and touch. I once heard his playing described as “three handed”—that is to say that he would provide melody with the right hand, bass tones with the left, and *both* hands shared in the role of harmony in the “third” part. This is even evident when looking at the transcription—Evans didn’t just play a melody over a bunch of chords; he was a master of voice leading.

Evans uses many interesting approaches in this solo, employing scale-tone triads, chord outlines, and the like. In measure 65, Evans uses a touch of blues. The passage starts with an ascending A minor pentatonic scale followed by a blue note (E $\flat$). We hear a similar hint of blues in measure 52 with his use of the *flat 3rd* (A $\flat$) and again in measure 69.

Fig. 8

21	Full Band
22	Slow Demo meas. 49-59
23	Slow Demo meas. 61-65
24	Rhythm Track

Intro
Rubato ♩ = 170

1

5

9

13

mp

rall.

17 *a tempo*

21

25

29 **Solo break**
In time ♩ = 180
mf

Bass and drums enter

33 C♯ C13 Bm7♭5 E7♯9 Am9 G♯o7

36 Gm9 C13 F♯ Bm7♭5 E7♯9

39 Am9 D9 Gm9 C13 F#

42 Fm9 Bb13 Cmaj7 E7#9 Am9 E7#9

45 Am9 D9 Dm9

48 Abm9/Db Db9 C# Bm7b5 E7#9 Am9 G#o7

52 Gm9 C9 F# Bm7b5 E7#9

55 Am9 D9 Gm9 C13 F#

58 Fm9 Bb9 Cmaj7 E7#9 Am9 D9

61 C/G Fmaj7/G G7alt. C#

64 Db13#11 C# C13 Bm7b5 E7#9

67 Am9 G#o7 Gm9 C13 F#

70 Bm7b5 E7#9 Am9 D9 Gm9 C13

73 F# Fm9 Bb13 Cmaj7 E7#9

76 Am9 E7#9 Am9 D9

79 Dm9 Abm9/Db Db9 C#

82 Bm7b5 E7#9 Am9 G#o7 Gm9 C9

85 F# Bm7b5 E7#9 Am9 D9 loca Gm9 C13

89 F# Fm9 Bb9 Cmaj7 E7#9 Am9 D9

93 C/G Fmaj7/G G7alt. C# Db13#11 C#

34 SKIDOO

Music by Bill Evans
As Played on *Blue in Green*

Figure 9—Intro

“34 Skidoo” is an interesting tune to play. The piece starts with a freewheeling rubato intro. The rhythmic notation on this figure is simply meant to give an approximation of Evans’s introduction from the *Blue in Green* album. Bass and drums enter once Evans establishes the tempo prior to the waltz section. The B section consists of a series of chords over a bass pedal point. Although I have transcribed Evans’s improvisation over the B section, you should improvise freely when you play the tune, as there is no “real” melody in this section.

25	Full Band
26	Rhythm Track meas. 15-61

Fig. 9

Intro A
Freely

1 *Solo piano* Dm/E E7 Am

5 Dm/E E7 Am

9 Dm/E E7 Am

13 Dm/E E7 Em(add9)

Bass and drums enter

♩ = 213

16 Dm11 Cm11 Bm11b5 E7alt.

20 Am(maj7) Bbm11 Abm11 Gm7b5 C7alt. Fm

25 F#m11 F#m11/E D#m7b5 G#7alt. C#m7 Cmaj7/B*

*Bass plays B pedal through meas. 44.

30 B7 Em/B Cmaj7/B

34 B7 Em/B Cmaj7/B

38 B7 Em/B

41 Cmaj7/B B7 Bm(add9)

44 Am11 F#m7b5 C9 F9

48 Em(maj7) Cm11 Bbm11 Am7b5 D7#9 Gm(maj7)

53 Ebm11 Dbm11 Cm7b5 F7b9 Bbm(maj7) Piano Solo

58 *Begin fade* *Fade out*

TURN OUT THE STARS

Lyric by Gene Lees

Music by Bill Evans

As Played on *Bill Evans at Town Hall*

Figure 10—Piano Solo

Bill Evans performed this solo piece as part of a three-part requiem in honor of his father. Evans provides an amazing breadth of emotion in his performance: poignancy, love, tenderness, reflection, anger, and sorrow. At first, I didn't understand his frenetic approach to the third section of the piece but, as I listened, I realized that I was hearing a true artistic outpouring by a man in grief.

In the first section of "Turn Out the Stars," Evans uses the "three-handed" technique discussed previously. He also utilizes chord outlining in the left hand that is found in much of the Romantic era piano music by composers such as Brahms and Chopin.

In the second section, we hear a left hand that comes out of the stride tradition. Most of the voicings in this section are typical of an earlier era during which "full-sounding" voicings such as 10ths were common. Evans alternates between fast and slow sections in much the same way that a classical composer might construct movements in a sonata.

The second slow section leads to a very difficult double-time section. It is interesting to note that he uses an almost uninterrupted series of triplets and sixteenth notes. As with the second section, Evans uses a left-hand style that is stride-like.

Perhaps the most striking part of "Turn Out the Stars" occurs in the last measure. The choice of a simple C# minor chord (with no extensions or alterations) is a touching contrast to the lush harmonies we hear up to that point.

27

Solo Piano

Fig. 10

Solo
Freely

The musical score for the piano solo of "Turn Out the Stars" is presented in three systems. The first system (measures 1-5) begins with a mezzo-piano (mp) dynamic. The second system (measures 6-10) continues the harmonic progression. The third system (measures 11-15) concludes the piece with a final chord. The score is written for piano with treble and bass staves.

Measures 1-5: Bm9b5, Bbm9/E, Am, Dm7, G7#9, Cmaj7, Fm7, Bb7.

Measures 6-10: Ebmaj7, Cm7, Am7, D7, Gmaj7, C#m7, F#7, Bmaj7.

Measures 11-15: Bbm7b5, Eb7, Abm7, Bb7#5, Ebm9.

16 A13sus4 A13b9 Dmaj9/A A9sus4 A13b9

20 Dmaj9/A G13sus4 G13b9 Cmaj9/G G7

24 Cmaj7/G C13 B9sus4 B+7 Em Bb9#11 A+7 Dm Ab13

29 G+7 Cm9 Eb9 Abmaj7 C7b9 Fm9 Fm7/Eb Dm7b5 G+7

34 Cm8 Eb7 Abmaj7 G7#11 Cmaj9 Bm9b5 E+ Am

39 Ab9sus4 Ab7b9 C#m F#7 Bm7b5 E7 Am7 A7

$\text{♩} = 84$

mf

43 Dm7 G7 Cmaj7

45 Fm7 Bb7 Ebmaj7 Cm7 Bbm7

47 Am7 D7 Gmaj7

49 C#m7 F#7 Bmaj7

51 Bbm7b5 Eb7

53 Abm7 Abm7/Gb Fm7b5 Bb7

55 Ebm9 Ebm7/Db Bmaj7 Ebm7/Bb

57 A13sus4 A7^{b9}5 Damj9/A B7^{b9}5 A9sus4 A13b9 Dmaj9/A G9sus4 G13

mp

62 Cmaj9/G C#o7 G9sus4 G13b9 Cmaj9/G

Rubato
B9sus4 B+7 Em7 Bb7#11

67 A+7 Dm Ab7#11 G+7 Cm7 Eb9 Abmaj7 C7b9

72 Fm9 Dm7b5 G+7 Cm8 Eb9sus4 Abmaj7 G7^{b9}11 Cmaj9

Musical score for measures 81-84 of "The Sound of Silence" by Simon & Garfunkel. The tempo is 120 BPM. The key signature is B minor (Bm7b5). The score is written for piano (p) and features a treble and bass staff. Measure 81 starts with a forte (f) dynamic. The melody in the treble staff includes triplets and a half note. The bass staff provides harmonic support with chords and single notes. Chord symbols Bm7b5, E7, and Am7 are indicated above the staff.

85 Fm7 Bb7 Ebmaj7

Measures 85-87 of the piano accompaniment for 'The Sound of Silence'. The key signature is B-flat major (three flats). Measure 85 features a treble clef with a descending eighth-note melody and a bass clef with a sustained Fm7 chord. Measure 86 features a treble clef with a descending eighth-note melody and a bass clef with a sustained Bb7 chord. Measure 87 features a treble clef with a descending eighth-note melody and a bass clef with a sustained Ebmaj7 chord. The treble clef part includes a triplet of eighth notes in measure 87.

89 C#m7 F#7 Bmaj7

91 Bbm7b5 Eb7

93 Abm7 Fm7b5 Bb7

95 Ebm7/Db Bmaj7 Ebm7/Bb

97 A9sus4 A7 Dmaj7/A

99 A9sus4 A7 Dmaj7/A

101 G9sus4 G7 Cmaj7/G A7

103 G9sus4 G7 Cmaj7 Rubato B+7 mf

106 Em7 Bb9#11 A+7 Dm7 Ab9#11 G7 Cm7 Eb7

111 Abmaj7 C7 Fm7 Dm7b5 G+7 Cm Eb7sus4

115 Abmaj7 G7 Cmaj9 Bm7b5 E7

118 Am7 Ab7 C#m7 F#9

121 Bm7b5 E7 Am7 Dm G7#9 Cmaj9 Fm7 Bb7

126 Ebmaj7 Bb7 Am7 D7 Gmaj7 C#m7 F#7b9 Bmaj7

131 Bbm7b5 Eb7 Abm7 Bb7sus4 Bb7 Ebm7

136 A13sus4 A13b9 Dmaj9/A A7sus4 A13b9 Dmaj9/A

141 G7sus4 G7b9 Cmaj9/G G7sus4 Cmaj7/G C13 B9sus4 B+7

146 Em7 Bb9#11 A+7 Dm7 Ab9#11 G+7 Cm7 Eb9

151 Abmaj7 C7b9 Fm9 Dm7b5 G+7 Cm Eb7sus4 Abmaj7 G7#11

156 Cmaj9 Bm9b5 E+ Am Ab9sus4 Ab7b9 C#m

rit. *pp*

VERY EARLY

Music by Bill Evans
As Played on *Moonbeams*

Figure 11—Solo

"Very Early" would be a good choice for a first Bill Evans transcription. The solo begins after two complete statements of the theme. It is not too long or difficult, yet we hear all of the quintessential Evans techniques: close-position left hand, chords of omission, left- and right-hand rhythmic doubling, motivic development, and rhythmic variety.

Evans uses an active left hand for much of this solo. Note how the left doubles many of the important rhythms in the solo line. As we have seen in many of these transcriptions, Evans uses vertical chord outlines to great effect. A good example occurs in measures 35–40, where he develops an interesting arpeggiated pattern.

Measures 41–44 provided a transcribing challenge. This passage transcends the bar line! Listen to the accompanying CD or Evans's original recording to get a clear idea of the phrasing for this passage.

Fig.11

28	Full Band
29	Slow Demo meas. 32-40
30	Rhythm Track

Solo
1 ♩ = 132
Cmaj7

Bb9 Eb♭ Ab7alt. Db♭

6 G7 C♯ Bb7alt. Dmaj9

10 Am9 F♯m7 B13 Em9

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14 $A\flat 13$ $D\flat \text{maj} 13$ $Dm9$ $G13$ $C\sharp$

18 $B\flat 13$ $E\flat\sharp$ $A\flat 7 \text{alt.}$ $D\flat \text{maj} 9$

22 $Dm9$ $G7 \text{alt.}$ $C\sharp$ $B\flat 13 \sharp 11$ $D \text{maj} 9$ $A \text{m} 9$

27 $F\sharp m7$ $B13$ $E \text{m} 9$ $A\flat 7 \text{alt.}$

31 $D\flat \text{maj} 9$ $Dm9$ $G13$ $C\sharp$ $B\flat 13$

35 Eb $\frac{9}{8}$ Ab13 Dbmaj9 Dm9 G13

39 C $\frac{9}{8}$ Bb13 Dmaj9 Am9

43 F#m7 B13 Em9 Ab13

47 Dbmaj9 G13 Cmaj7 Bb13

51 Ebmaj9 Ab7alt. Db $\frac{9}{8}$ G7

FIVE

Music by Bill Evans
As Played on *New Jazz Conceptions*

Figure 12—Section A

"Five" was especially fun to record. As you can imagine, the rhythm of the melody chorus is challenging. Fortunately, Clipper Anderson and Mark Ivester (bassist and drummer, respectively, on this Signature Licks recording) were easily up to the task. From a performance standpoint, the bridge provides the biggest challenge. Here, the drummer stays in 4/4 for eight measures while the piano and bass go through a series of 5:4 and 4:3 measures. I found it helpful to practice with a metronome (and Evans' recording, of course). If you can tap your foot *and* feel the underlying 4/4, you will have no trouble playing this piece.

In the solo section, we hear Evans as the consummate bop pianist. The chord changes are based on "I Got Rhythm." Unlike traditional "rhythm" changes, Evans uses a circle of fourths progression. In the first two A sections we have a circle progression starting on F#7: F#7–B7–E7–A7–D7–G7–C7–F7–B♭. It is interesting to note that the last A section is different from the first. Here we have another circle progression, but in this instance, the progression is F7–B♭7–E♭7–A♭7–D♭–G♭7–Cm7–F7–B♭.

Evans takes advantage of the unique harmonic progression. He outlines chord tones in many sections of the solo (meas. 48, 55, 56, 57, 58, etc.). In addition to chord tones and scales, Evans uses many embellishments typical of bop solos, such as chromatic approach tones (meas. 60–61), turns (beats 1 and 2 of meas. 51), and changing tones (beat 4 of meas. 67). If you like this style of playing, I would encourage you to learn the vocabulary by practicing short melodic units in a variety of keys—rest assured that Bill Evans did the same thing!

- 31** Full Band
- 32** Slow Demo
meas. 55-62
- 33** Slow Demo
meas. 118-127
- 34** Rhythm Track

Fig. 12

A
Medium Uptempo Swing ♩ = 200
N.C.

Bass

Piano N.C.*

* Bass pedals on F through meas. 12.

13 $B\flat$ $Gm7$ $Cm7$ $F7$ Dm $G7$ $Cm7$ $F7$ $B\flat$ $B\flat/A\flat$

18 $E\flat/G$ $E\flat m/G\flat$ $B\flat/F$ $B\flat$ $Gm7$ $Cm7$ $F7$

23 $Dm7$ $G7$ $Cm7$ $F7$ $B\flat$ $B\flat/A\flat$ $E\flat/G$ $E\flat m/G\flat$ $B\flat/F$

28 **B** $Am7\flat5$ $D7$ $Gm7$ $A\flat m7$

* Drums continue to play in 4/4.

33 $D\flat7$ $Gm7$ $C7$ $F7$ $F\sharp m7$

38 B7 Bb Gm7 Cm7 F7 Dm7 G7

42 Cm7 F7 Bb Bb/Ab Eb/G Ebm/Gb

45 Bb/F F#7 B7

48 E7 A7 D7 G7 C7 F7

51 Bb Bb/D Eb E°7 Bb/F

54 F#7 B7 E7 A7

57 D7 G7 C7 F7 Bb Bb/D

60 Eb E7 Bb D7

64 G7 C7

68 F7 F7 Bb7

72 Eb7 Ab7 Db7 Gb7 Cm7 F7 Bb Bb/D

76 Eb E°7 Bb F#7 B7

80 E7 A7 D7 G7 C7 F7 Bb Bb/D

84 Eb E°7 Bb/F F#7 B7

88 E7 A7 D7 G7 C7 F7 Bb Bb/D

[illegible]

96 D7 G7 A $\flat$ m7 D7 Gm7

The musical notation for measures 96-100 is as follows:

- Measure 96:** Treble clef, D7 chord. Notes: D4 (half), E4 (quarter), F#4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), D4 (half).
- Measure 97:** Treble clef, G7 chord. Notes: G4 (half), A4 (quarter), B4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), G4 (half).
- Measure 98:** Treble clef, A $\flat$ m7 chord. Notes: A $\flat$ 4 (half), B $\flat$ 4 (quarter), C5 (quarter), B $\flat$ 4 (quarter), A $\flat$ 4 (half).
- Measure 99:** Treble clef, D7 chord. Notes: D4 (half), E4 (quarter), F#4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), D4 (half).
- Measure 100:** Treble clef, Gm7 chord. Notes: G4 (half), A4 (quarter), B4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), G4 (half).

The bass line for measures 96-100 is as follows:

- Measure 96:** Bass clef, D7 chord. Notes: D3 (half), E3 (quarter), F#3 (quarter), E3 (quarter), D3 (half).
- Measure 97:** Bass clef, G7 chord. Notes: G3 (half), A3 (quarter), B3 (quarter), A3 (quarter), G3 (half).
- Measure 98:** Bass clef, A $\flat$ m7 chord. Notes: A $\flat$ 3 (half), B $\flat$ 3 (quarter), C4 (quarter), B $\flat$ 3 (quarter), A $\flat$ 3 (half).
- Measure 99:** Bass clef, D7 chord. Notes: D3 (half), E3 (quarter), F#3 (quarter), E3 (quarter), D3 (half).
- Measure 100:** Bass clef, Gm7 chord. Notes: G3 (half), A3 (quarter), B3 (quarter), A3 (quarter), G3 (half).

100

Gb7 F7 F7 Bb7

The musical score for 'The Girl on the Train' is written for piano. It features a treble and bass staff. The key signature has two flats (Bb and Eb). The tempo is marked 'Moderato'. The score includes a variety of musical notations such as eighth notes, sixteenth notes, and chords. The first four measures are labeled with the following chords: Gb7, F7, F7, and Bb7. The score is divided into measures by vertical bar lines.

104 Eb7 Ab7 Db7 Gb7 Cm7 F7 Bb Bb/D

The musical score for measures 104-107 of 'The Sound of Silence' is shown. The key signature is B-flat major (two flats). The melody in the treble clef consists of eighth and quarter notes. The bass line in the bass clef features a steady eighth-note accompaniment. Chord symbols are placed above the staff: Eb7, Ab7, Db7, Gb7, Cm7, F7, Bb, and Bb/D.

108 Eb E°7 Bb

The musical score for 'The Rose Tree' is presented in a grand staff format, featuring a treble and bass clef. The key signature is B-flat major (two flats). The score is divided into three measures. The first measure contains a melodic line in the treble staff starting on G4, moving down to F4, E4, D4, C4, and B3, with a triplet of eighth notes (B3, A3, G3) in the second half. The bass staff has a whole rest. The second measure continues the melody in the treble staff with notes G4, F4, E4, D4, C4, and B3, with a triplet of eighth notes (B3, A3, G3) in the second half. The bass staff has a whole rest. The third measure features a melodic line in the treble staff starting on G4, moving down to F4, E4, D4, C4, and B3, with a triplet of eighth notes (B3, A3, G3) in the second half. The bass staff has a whole rest. The score is marked with '108' at the beginning, and the chords Eb, E°7, and Bb are indicated above the first, second, and third measures respectively.

111 F#7 B7 E7 A7 D7 G7

114 C7 F7 Bb Bb/D Eb E°7 Bb/F

118 F#7 B7 E7 A7

121 D7 G7 C7 F7 Bb Bb/D

124 Eb E°7 Bb D7

128 G7

131 C7 F7

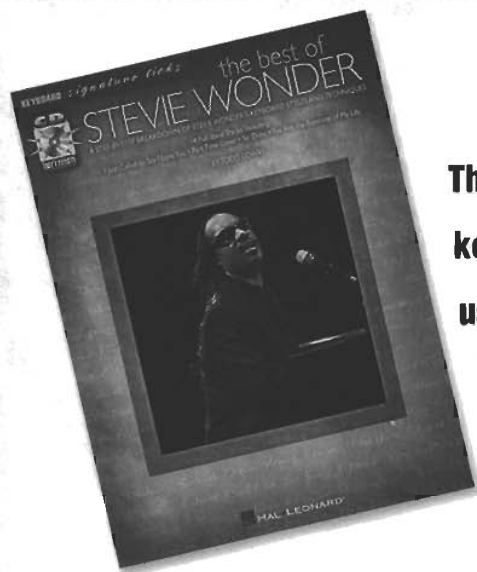
134 F7 Bb7 Eb7 Ab7

137 Db7 Gb7 Cm7 F7 Bb Bb/D

140 Eb Eo7 Bb

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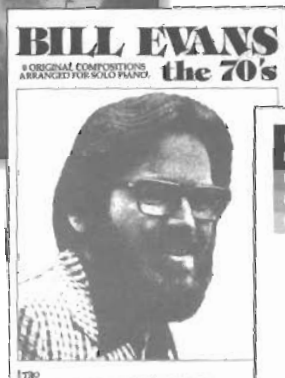
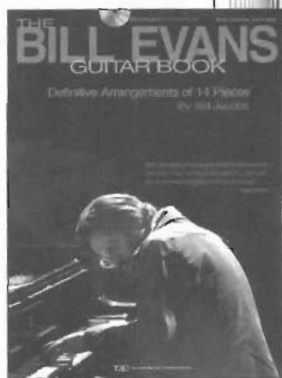
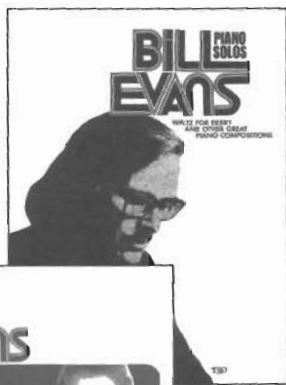
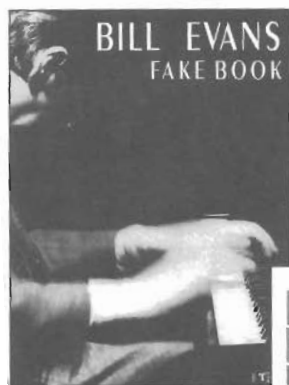
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